

Reverse Outline and Formal Outline for AP

Reverse Outline

Paragraph 4 (last paragraph written)

What it does: Starts to introduce COVID-19 and technological developments, noting that online services have become more profitable, but the paragraph is incomplete.

Main point: COVID-19 accelerated the shift toward digital/streaming media.
Connects to thesis: Relates to the 'infrastructural shift' mentioned in the thesis, but it's currently undeveloped and not linked back to economic or geographic impacts.

Paragraph 3

What it does: Argues that California's strong unions make it more profitable for studios to relocate to states/countries with weaker labor protections. Cites Economic Policy Institute's statement about unionization desire.

Main point: Union strength in California increases labor costs, encouraging relocation.

Connects to thesis: Supports the 'labor union' factor in Hollywood's exodus mentioned in the thesis.

Paragraph 2

What it does: Explains motion picture incentives (MPIs), provides definitions, cites Michael Thom, and gives an example (Newsom's \$750M program). Shows that while California's incentives are strong, nearly all states have them, making California less competitive.

Main point: MPIs alone can't keep Hollywood in California because other states offer similar or better incentives.

Connects to thesis: Matches the 'higher MPIs' solution mentioned in the thesis but also reveals its limitations.

Paragraph 1 (intro)

What it does: Introduces Hollywood's move away from California, mentions surface-level causes (rising union costs), and deeper cause (shift to online streaming). Lays out three proposed solutions in thesis form.

Main point: California can't rely solely on tax changes; needs combined strategies to keep Hollywood production.

Connects to thesis: It is the thesis, though it's currently a bit wordy and unclear in priority/order.

Analysis of Issues & Revision Tasks

- Incomplete development: The COVID/digitalization paragraph needs full development and clear links to economics, labor, and geography.
- Thesis clarity: The thesis tries to cover too much at once; needs rewording to show a clearer argument order.
- Evidence integration: Paragraph 3 (unions) and paragraph 2 (MPIs) could benefit from analysis connecting them directly to job loss and economic impact.
- Order: Current order is intro → MPI → unions → digital shift. This skips showing the scale of the decline with concrete data first.
- Transitions: Need smoother logical flow between paragraphs to show cause-and-effect.

Revised Plan / Ideal Flow

1. Intro: Brief hook (possibly local economic example), then thesis: clearly state the main cause(s) of Hollywood's exodus and the core argument for keeping it in California.
2. Context & Scale of Decline: Give concrete statistics on job loss, filming drop, and economic hit before explaining why.
3. Reason #1 – Economics of Production Costs: MPI competition, why California's advantages are eroding.
4. Reason #2 – Labor Costs & Unions: Strong unions in CA vs. weaker/absent ones elsewhere.
5. Reason #3 – Structural Digital Shift: COVID + streaming growth changing production patterns.
6. Policy/Industry Responses: Outline proposed solutions in the same order as the problems above.
7. Conclusion: Tie back to thesis, connect local economy and suburban communities, and restate call to action.

Formal Outline (Ideal Version)

I. Introduction

Hook: Local economic example (e.g., restaurant owner affected by Hollywood flight)

Background: Hollywood's historic connection to SoCal economy

Thesis: Hollywood's relocation is driven by production cost competition, labor dynamics, and a digital media shift—California must combine competitive MPIs, labor strategy, and industry restructuring to retain production.

II. The Scale of the Problem

Stats: Job losses, filming decline, spending drops

How this impacts surrounding communities

III. Economic Competition – MPIs

What MPIs are & examples
California vs. other states & countries
Why incentives alone aren't enough

IV. Labor Costs – Union Dynamics

Role of WGA, SAG-AFTRA, and others
Costs vs. benefits of strong unions
Comparative advantage for non-CA locations

V. Digital Shift & COVID-19 Impact

Streaming's rise during COVID-19
Changes in production location needs
Mixed expert opinions on benefits for workers

VI. Proposed Solutions

Strengthen MPIs strategically
Support labor but reduce relocation incentives
Encourage industry adaptation to digital production

VII. Conclusion

Reconnect to SoCal communities
Restate thesis in light of evidence
Call to action for policymakers and industry leaders